

Speaker 1: Good afternoon. Thank you again for participating in this call. As we mentioned in the message that we sent, we've been talking about I would like to learn more about your views. I believe your experience and perspective would be very helpful for the project. Would it be okay for me to record this interview before we start? I will use this recording only for transcription, for taking notes.

Speaker 2: Thank you. Of course it would be appropriate.

Speaker 1: Thank you.

Speaker 2: I will help as much as I can.

Speaker 1: Thank you very much. First of all, how old are you?

Speaker 2: [31-35].

Speaker 1: [31-35].

Speaker 1: How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2: We have been together for [11-15] years.

Speaker 1: Do you have children?

Speaker 2: Yes. I have [1-5]. I have [1-5] son and [1-5] daughter.

Speaker 1: Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2: Family, my husband, me and my children.

Speaker 1: [1-5] people.

Speaker 2: There are [1-5] of us.

Speaker 1: So what is your main source of income? I mean what is your current job?

Speaker 2: I am a [occupation] and my husband is a [occupation].

Speaker 1: How would you like me to address your partner? I can call your boyfriend, I can call your husband, I can call your husband, I can call your lover.

Speaker 2: You can call him my husband, whatever you like.

Speaker 1: Can you tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

Speaker 2: Let's say ours was an arranged marriage. My sisters and my grandparents have an apartment across the street from each other. Through them. But first we met, we agreed, then the families gave their approval. We were engaged for [1-5] months and then we got married.

Speaker 1: How did it develop? When did this happen, when did you meet?

Speaker 2: We met in [Month], [Month] in [Year]. [15-20] days later we got engaged. We got engaged on the [date] of [Month]. We had our engagement. Then our wedding date was set, and on the [Month], we had our wedding. So we got along well with each other and we're very happy.

Speaker 1: How would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2: How would I evaluate it compared to my friends? Honestly, I never thought about it like that. Because I've never seen any difficulties or anything, I've never compared anyone to myself. I've never thought that I should be like this, I should do that.

Speaker 1: In terms of relationship, how would you evaluate the quality of your own relationship?

Speaker 2: I can adapt to any environment. I am a quiet person. When I say I am a quiet person, I defend my rights when necessary, but I am not a person who makes too much noise.

Speaker 1: Well, would you like to explain why you say that? Why do you think like that?

Speaker 2: Why do I think like that? For example, even if something happens to me, in order not to offend, in order to keep quiet, my mother told me when I was getting married, you know, when one of you speaks, one of you keep quiet, even if you argue, even with your spouse, always one of you speaks and one of you keeps quiet. My mother, for example, has been married for [46-50] years. She said that she would never, under any circumstances, talk when my father was talking, my father wouldn't talk when she was talking. I don't know maybe I'm following the example of my mother.

Speaker 1: Can I ask you how many romantic relationships you had in the past?

Speaker 2: I have not had any romantic relationships. I haven't, but my husband has. He will tell you about it.

Speaker 1: So what do you think makes a relationship of high quality for you?

Speaker 2: Respect, mutual respect, love (sevgi) and understanding.

Speaker 1: And what makes it low quality?

Speaker 2: Low quality when people who don't respect each other, despise each other, I mean, humiliate each other sometimes.

Speaker 1: For high quality, you said being respectful, being lovers. Can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2: I mean, when there is mutual respect and love (sevgi), you can overcome everything. I mean, you can also overcome financially, you can talk, you can get along. I mean, you can overcome all kinds of material and spiritual things. But when the other person doesn't work, for example, you fight if you insist like "I want this, I want that", in this way, resentment, fights, everything can happen to people.

Speaker 1: You said that what makes low quality is disrespect and contempt. Can you explain this a little bit? Why do you think like this?

Speaker 2: Well, how can I put it? When the other person doesn't respect you, people inevitably get offended. I don't know, I think so.

Speaker 1: Well, would you say that close relationships are respectful relationships?

Speaker 2: Of course, I believe that mutual respect and love (sevgi) can always overcome everything.

Speaker 1: So, can you tell me more about how a person knows that they are in a respectful relationship?

Speaker 2: Well, you can tell by the way they look, by their eyes, by their attitude.

Speaker 1: So, in your own relationship, when would you say that your relationship is respectful?

Speaker 2: When? Of course always, respectful, in that loving way. We never have arguments. I mean very rarely.

Speaker 1: When do you think he was the least respectful?

Speaker 2: To me, I don't know, it never happened to me. I mean, I can't answer because it didn't happen.

Speaker 1: So, what are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2: Mutual tolerance, understanding each other, even from the way they look at each other, people understand each other, for example, when there is a problem, people understand the other person already from their looks, their attitude.

Speaker 1: Why do you think so?

Speaker 2: Because I understand, I mean, when there is a problem with my partner, for example, he inevitably becomes quiet, calms down, and becomes stagnant. I mean, he also understands if something happens, what happened. He understands me too.

Speaker 1: So, for you, for you, what is love (aşk)?

Speaker 2: For us love (aşk) is understanding each other, listening, tolerance, respect, love (sevgi), not to hurt each other.

Speaker 1: So, how do you know if your partner loves you? And before that, let me ask you, how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2: Of course it is important. If you say how important each other's love (aşk) is, for example, you understand the person, whether he loves you or not is already very noticeable from his behavior. For example, people say that where love (aşk) ends, love (sevgi) also ends. I mean, inevitably, there will be uneasiness.

Speaker 1: So how important is love (aşk) for you?

Speaker 2: Love (aşk) is important for everyone. It is very important for me too.

Speaker 1: So, how do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2: By the way he talks, by his behavior, by the way he looks at me.

Speaker 1: Can you expand on that a little bit more? I mean, if you want, you can support it with examples, you know, current events that come to your mind.

Speaker 2: What do you mean by current events?

Speaker 1: From your daily life, I mean, how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2: I said that people value each other, for example, with a small surprise, with a flower, with a conversation, when he brings a flower without a reason.

Speaker 1: What would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2: Challenges, honestly we don't have any challenges. We only have a little bit about the schooling of the children, that's all. I mean, about the children, you know, a little bit.

Inevitably, when the children become adolescents, parents try a little bit. So we don't have any other problems, thank God.

Speaker 1: So do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2: No. Very rarely, as I said, we fight because of the children.

Speaker 1: And how often would you say these fights are?

Speaker 2: There is no such frequency. I mean, for example, about the child, for example, since the child usually tells me, this time when he doesn't want his father to hear it and I say I can't hide it from your father, when I tell his father, we have a small thing. That's all.

Speaker 1: So how do you solve these fights?

Speaker 2: By keeping quiet. I tell him the problem. The father confronts the boy, they talk and it's over.

Speaker 1: So apart from this solution, what do you think are the other ways to maintain the relationship?

Speaker 2: Normally, I have been married to my husband for [11-15] years. We didn't have any arguments. Only about the children, about the boy. The boy started high school. This year we're floundering a bit. I mean, I shut up about that, I tell his father, I shut up, his father confronts him and it ends like that.

Speaker 1: Would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2: Of course. I would say that.

Speaker 1: Can you explain this a little bit? Why is that?

Speaker 2: Why? Now, when I speak and my husband responds to me, it will get worse. I told you that I am following in my mother's footsteps. My husband is the same way, for example, he says, "Look, you're shutting up, you're sitting down". For example, when you react back, this fight will grow. This time, it will be very difficult for you to get along with your spouse, there will be uneasiness at home, disturbance, we won't have peace at home.

Speaker 1: What you call home life is an example of the daily functioning of life. Can you give a concrete example?

Speaker 2: Outside?

Speaker 1: No, I want a concrete example from you. You know, about life in terms of daily functioning, for example, that this relationship is good for you.

Speaker 2: For me, I am satisfied. I mean it is good for me. I am satisfied with my husband. My spouse is also satisfied with me. I mean, I don't quite understand what you mean by concrete, but I mean that the other people, those around me, also know that my husband cares for me, that I care for him. I mean, my neighbors and friends always appreciate me in the same way. I mean, from the way they talk, they sometimes say that we envy you. You are very satisfied. You have no complaints.

Speaker 1: Has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2: No. It hasn't changed me at all. I am the same as I am.

Speaker 1: And did your partner change during that relationship? If so, in what way? What changes happened?

Speaker 2: No. I don't think my partner has changed either. He is the same to me as I know him. Same to the environment. Same with the children.

Speaker 1: So the person you were before the relationship is the same person you are now?

Speaker 2: The same. There is no difference.

Speaker 1: Your spouse?

Speaker 2: The same. There is no difference.

Speaker 1: Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2: I trust my husband. He is someone who takes care of his family. Someone who doesn't let anyone oppress him. I mean, he is someone who defends me when necessary. That's why I trust him.

Speaker 1: Now I will show you some questionnaires and I will read them for you to understand better: "My partner usually really listens to me." From one to 9, one is not true at all and 9 is completely true. There are numbers from one to 9. I want you to choose 1 number from them.

Speaker 2: 8.

Speaker 1: If I asked you that my partner really listens to me, on a scale of one not true at all to nine completely true, what would your answer be?

Speaker 2: I would say 8.

Speaker 1: Okay. Can you explain a little bit why you say 8?

Speaker 2: Well, sometimes. Sometimes he is distracted. He seems to listen but he doesn't. That's why I didn't say one hundred percent.

Speaker 1: So why not 7 or 9?

Speaker 2: 7 or 9. I don't know. I thought of 8. Suddenly I said 8. 9 was the highest. You know what I'm saying, sometimes he gets distracted. Suddenly his mind goes somewhere else. That's why.

Speaker 1: If I asked you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs, what would your answer be from one to 9?

Speaker 2: Of course 9.

Speaker 1: May I know why you answered 9?

Speaker 2: Because whatever I ask, he tries to do as much as he can. If he can't do it, he says wait a little bit. When the time comes, I will do it for you.

Speaker 1: Can you give me some concrete examples of what happens?

Speaker 2: Sir?

Speaker 1: Can you give me concrete examples of when these things happen?

Speaker 2: For example, if I need something, I wait. I wait. But when I insist, he gets a little stubborn. That's why he doesn't like to stick to it. I say it once and wait. He says come on, we get prepared immediately and we go, for example.

Speaker 1: You gave the answer 9. Why 9 and not 8?

Speaker 2: Because he does it. As much as he can, he tries to do it. You know, even if it is late, he does it.

Speaker 1: I hope you don't mind me asking. If this is too sensitive for you to share, please feel free to say so. But I would like to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2: Well, when we say sexual intercourse, we have no problem. But I mean it happens.

Speaker 1: Thank you for answering. So how satisfied are you with your sexual life?

Speaker 2: I am satisfied. I have no complaints.

Speaker 1: Would you like to explain a little more why you say that?

Speaker 2: How can I say it? I can't explain.

Speaker 1: Okay. Thank you. How satisfied are you with your relationship in general? I'll put it like this. I am completely dissatisfied. Very dissatisfied. Somewhat dissatisfied. I'm not sure, I'm undecided. Somewhat satisfied. This goes on and on... I'm very satisfied. I am completely satisfied. Since you answered completely satisfied, I will show you a scale. How would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship? 0 not satisfied at all. 10 completely satisfied. Again 1,2,3,4,5,7,8,9.

Speaker 2: 10 I am completely satisfied.

Speaker 1: May I know why you answered 10?

Speaker 2: Why? Because there is no problem with my relationship. I mean, because it always meets my needs.

Speaker 1: Why 10 and not 9?

Speaker 2: Because it does, I mean because it meets my needs, so I never thought about 9.

Speaker 1: Did your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker 2: Yes. I don't have much expectations. It is what it is.

Speaker 1: Can you explain this a little bit more?

Speaker 2: I mean it meets my expectations. Because I don't look for anything else, I don't think about it. So we are enough for each other.

Speaker 1: We are about to finish. I want to summarize what we have been talking about for the last half an hour.

You said that you are satisfied with your relationship in general.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: The important things for you in a relationship are respect, love and mutual understanding.

Speaker 2: Exactly.

Speaker 1: You even said that in a quality relationship, a respectful relationship is a high quality relationship.

Were these things true?

Speaker 2: Because when mutual respect ends, love (sevgi) ends, love (aşk) ends. Everything ends. So I think it is right.

Speaker 1: Are there a few more things you would like to add, if you want to talk a little more?

Speaker 2: Young people nowadays, for example, they care about the slightest thing. There are many divorces, many things happen. So mutual respect and love (sevgi) are important for everything. When you see respect and love (sevgi) from the other person, your love (aşk) continues, your love (sevgi) continues. We see it a lot. There are many around us. For example, they are newly married. But I don't know, I wonder if we take things in our stride. Are today's young people taking it easy? I don't know. That's why, for me, mutual respect and love (sevgi) doesn't end love (aşk) anyway. It doesn't end love (sevgi) either.

Speaker 1: Thank you very much. Before I finish I would like to talk to you about how I will handle the data. As a research project we want to be as transparent as ethically possible and so I would like to know which data sharing option is the most suitable for you. So I will give you two options, the first option is to share some parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will be identifiable to you. will not contain any information. Your de-identified interview transcript will then be available for other researchers to read. Our second option, if you don't mind, is that if you want to be a little bit more daring, you can choose to keep your entire interview transcript sensitive and highly identifiable. we're going to strip it of the details. That is, anonymized sharing. In this option, you'll be able to share. There is a very small chance that someone will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down the choices of who they believe to be among their colleagues.

Again, I want to emphasize that no sensitive information will be shared. Which of the two options do you prefer?

Speaker 2: Either one makes no difference to me. Either one is fine with me, whichever is compatible.

Speaker 1: It's going to be up to you, so I'm asking you, you know, option one. second option?

Speaker 2: Will the second option be exactly what we talked about?

Speaker 1: No. Sensitive things will be separated from it. It will be anonymized and shared. It's more than the first option.

Speaker 2: It will be more open.

Speaker 1: Uh-huh.

Speaker 2: It doesn't matter. It can be two.

Speaker 1: Should I say two?

Speaker 2: Say two.

Speaker 1: Thank you.

Speaker 2: Thank you very much.

Speaker 1: And thank you very much for participating in this study.

I want you to know that the study was also conducted in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France and the USA. I would like to. In order for this work to be a success, there is one more thing we would like to ask of you, if that is okay with you. Could you suggest two close people in your life as candidates? I will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this study. I will not interview the couples I ask you for or the candidates I ask you for. I will call those candidates and say that our daughter is looking for them or a researcher is looking for them and I will call them and ask them for couples. I will not interview the people you suggest.

Speaker 2: With someone else through someone else.

Speaker 1: Exactly.

Speaker 2: I can suggest my brother and his wife.

Speaker 1: I need to get their contact information from you to contact them. But if you don't want it to be shared in the recording, I will close the recording.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: Thank you very much for participating again.